

Welcome New Members

OLLI Digital Explorers SIG

David Shamlin August 2026

Icebreaker

1. What is do you enjoy doing with your device(s)?

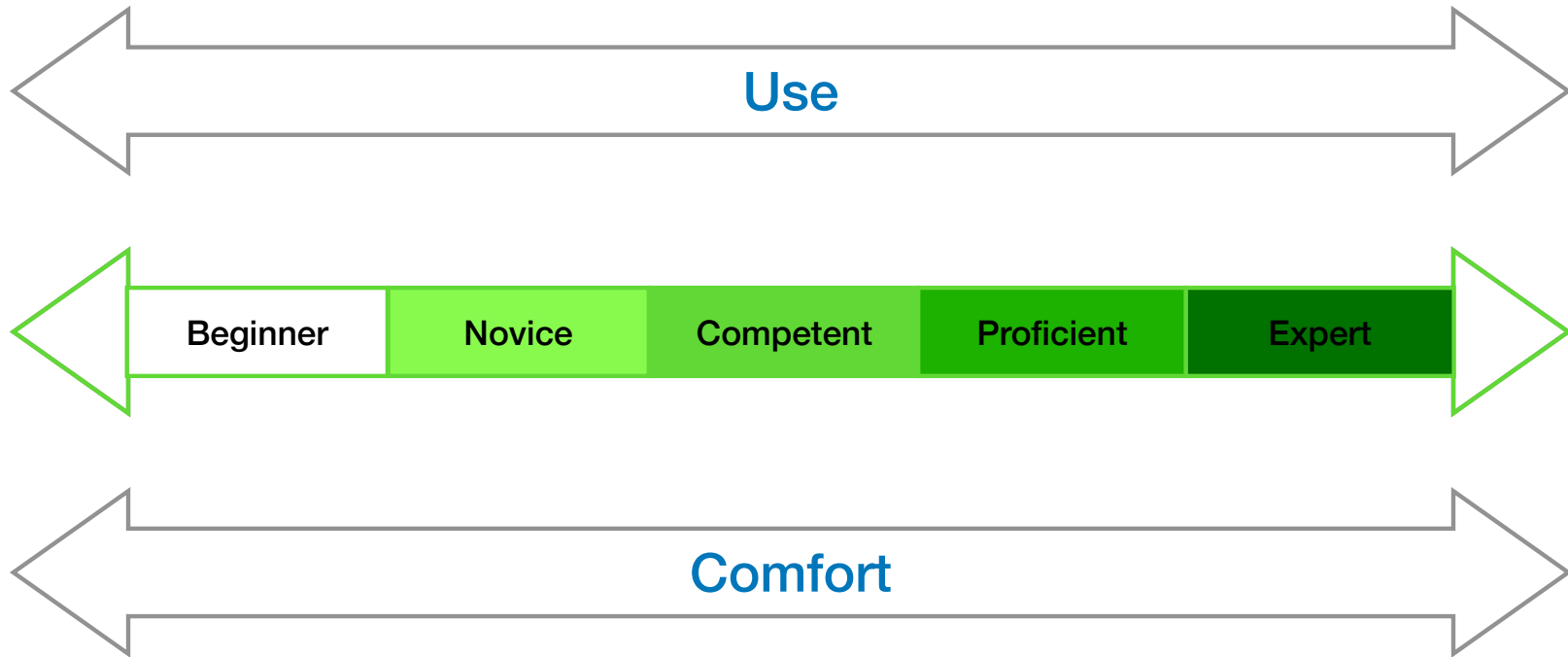
Or name something you do with your device(s) you get a lot of value from.

2. What is something about your device(s) that frustrates you?

3. What would you like to get out of this SIG?

Or why did you choose to join the SIG?

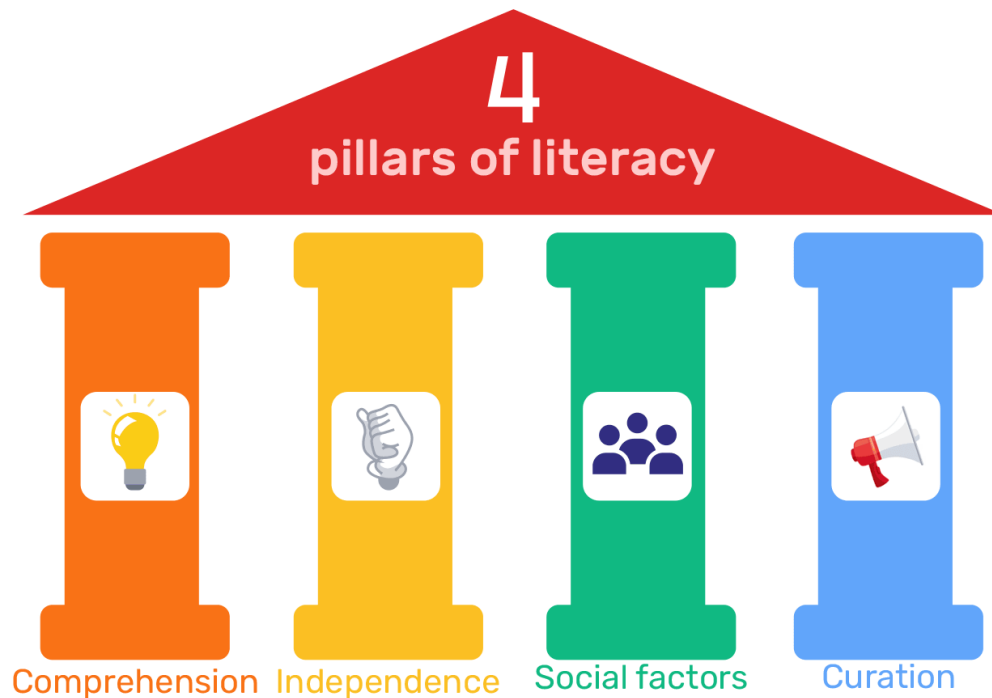
What kind of devices—i.e., computer, laptop, and/or phone—do you have?



Digital literacy enables you to curate and consume information responsibly. It empowers you to seek credible and reliable sources, create meaningful content, and foster communities by connecting like-minded people on various platforms. In essence, it's about **knowing how to navigate the digital world with purpose and confidence**.

A digitally literate person is someone who possesses both technical and cognitive skills to process information in various formats, utilizes different technologies effectively, and engages in digital spaces to collaborate with others and contribute positively to society.

— [*University of the Potomac*](#)



Further Reading

- Team Community: [What is Digital Literacy? And Why It Matters](#)
- EdTechReview: [What is Digital Literacy, Its Importance, and Challenges?](#)
- Technopedia: [Digital Literacy \(Digital Fluency\)](#)

Skill Levels

1. **Beginner** (basic knowledge)

You have a basic understanding of common concepts and techniques associated with a skill but have little to no understanding of how to perform the skill. You need assistance to learn the basics and seek references/resources to gain an initial understanding.

2. **Novice** (limited experience)

You have some limited/initial experience practicing the skill; you are deepening your understanding of how associated hardware/software “mechanics” apply to the skill. You may be starting to use the skill to complete tasks/actions you perform when you use related software on your device(s). You continue to frequently depend on references/resources (somewhere between 50% to 75% of the time) to assist you. You are not expected to work autonomously, and must aim to focus on enhancing your own skill or knowledge, whilst understanding issues, concepts, terminologies, and principles related to this competency. You must also hold the ability to seek out and utilize the resource material relevant to this competency.

3. **Competent** (practical application)

About 80% of the time, you are able to complete tasks/actions related to the skill successfully without the help of references/resources.. Help from an expert may be required at certain times, as to be expected. At this level of proficiency level, you are usually able to relatively easily and independently adapt if/when related software updates change the way you perform the skill. You tend to only turn to related references/resources for assistance with advanced applications of the skill.

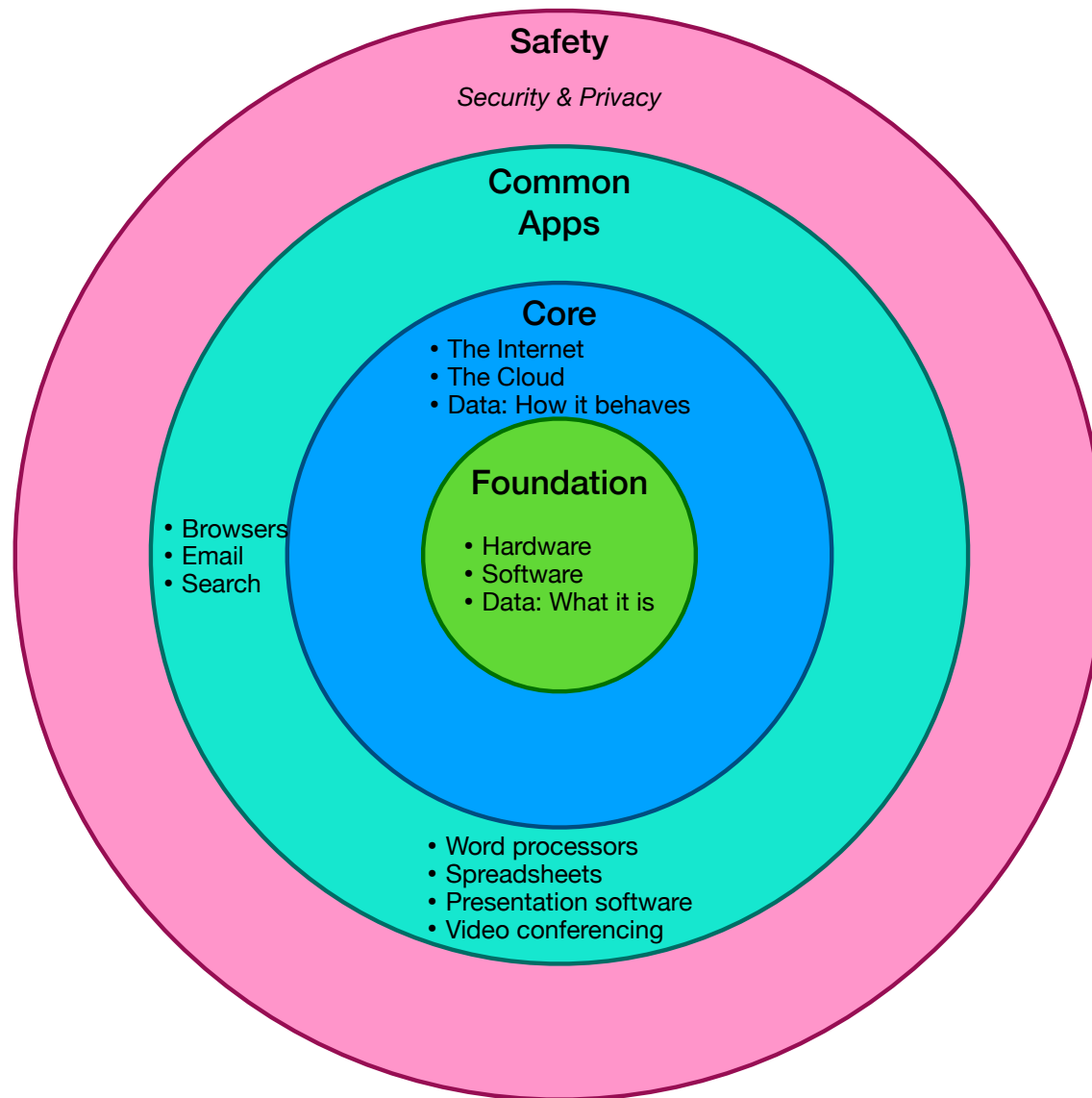
4. **Proficient** (applied theory)

You can apply the skill whenever needed and without further assistance from resources. On relatively few occasions, you may still refer to related documentation. You could act as a resource to someone else who is a beginner/novice with the skill

5. **Expert** (recognized authority)

Your proficiency with the skill is at a level that you are able to use it easily and without assistance. Your understanding of the hardware/software “mechanics” related to the skill are deep enough for you to be able to apply the skill in “new to you” contexts if/when you discover a use for the skill in different contexts.

<https://olli-shamlin.github.io/design/index.html>



Societal Impacts

- Digital Rights
- Social Media
- Artificial Intelligence
- Surveillance Marketing
- Misinformation, Disinformation, and Deepfakes
- Cryptocurrency
- Speculation Markets
- IoT: the Internet of Things

Options for Next Meeting Topic

1. Start Software unit
 1. Answer recently raised questions
 1. How do I uninstall an app? —> *Installing / uninstalling apps*
 2. How do I assess if/when it is “safe” to install an app?
 3. Why does my device tell me there is an app I can/should download when I visit some sites?
2. Repeat Hardware unit (and then proceed with the Software unit)
3. Address some common challenges
 1. Files: I can’t find the file I just saved! Where did it go?
 2. Email
 1. I can’t find an email I just read and know I didn’t delete.
 2. Can I reduce the amount of junk mail in my inbox?
 3. Is there a limit to how many emails I can keep?
 3. Browsers
 1. Cookies: What are they? How do I respond to “accept/deny/only necessary” type dialogs I see when I visit some sites?
 2. Cache: What is it? Why and when should I clear it?
 3. Address bar
 4. What is “privacy mode” or “privacy windows”?
 5. Settings
 1. There are so many; how do I know what they all do?
 2. Side effects
 6. “Reading the Screen”